InternInsight

CS310 - Step 1 Project Proposal - Group 41

Group Members

Ali Kaan Koç - 33832
Efe Osmanağaoğlu - 33979
Kaan Bayri - 35601
Selin Ildeniz - 35847

Step 1 Coordinator: Ali Kaan Koç

Project Overview

InternInsight is a mobile application idea where SABANCI University students can share and explore internship experiences at companies, research institutions, and universities. Job ads on platforms such as LinkedIn may not clearly reflect the actual work or expectations of a department. By reading real experiences written by past interns, students can decide whether an organization or department suits them and better understand what to expect.

Core Features

- **Accounts:** Users can register, sign in, and create a basic profile.
- **Internship Experiences:** Students can read experiences shared by other interns. Once their verification request is approved, they can publish an experience for the approved organization and edit or delete their own posts.
- **Search and Filtering:** Users can filter internship experiences by country and city, then search for companies, research institutes, or universities and view experiences for the selected organization. They can also filter by internship role. Results will be retrieved from MySQL through the backend.
- **Verification:** Students submit an internship completion document and select the relevant organization. A designated admin from the project team reviews requests through an admin-only screen and approves or rejects them. Students can view Pending, Approved, or Rejected status in their profiles. Approval permits posting for that organization. This is a manual document review, not official university verification.

Data Requirements

The application will be developed using Flutter and Dart. A Python REST API will connect Flutter to MySQL; the app will not access MySQL directly. No third-party data API is planned. MySQL will store user profiles, organizations, internship experiences, and verification requests. Each experience will include an author ID, organization ID, position, department, duration, location, technologies used, and description. Verification records will include the applicant, organization, document reference, and review status. Documents will be stored in a private directory on the backend host, with references stored in MySQL.

Potential Challenges

Backend and teamwork: Each member will run Python and MySQL locally. Backend code, SQL schema scripts, synthetic sample data, and setup instructions will be shared through GitHub to keep environments consistent. Credentials will be configured locally and excluded from Git. The Android emulator will reach the backend through 10.0.2.2; physical devices will use the computer's local network IP. HTTP

will be enabled only in the Android debug configuration for local testing; any public deployment will use HTTPS. Synchronizing schema changes and handling failed requests will require coordination.

Authentication and privacy: Passwords will be stored as salted hashes using a password-hashing library. Login will issue expiring access tokens stored securely on the device. The backend will validate tokens and enforce post ownership, admin permissions, and verification approval. Documents will require authorized access, have file type and size restrictions, and be deleted after review while retaining the decision. Students will redact unnecessary personal details; testing will use synthetic documents.
Week 14 demo: One designated laptop will run MySQL, Python, and the Android emulator together. We will test connectivity, login, verification, and posting beforehand using sample accounts. A second member will maintain a tested local setup as backup, avoiding dependence on external hosting.

Optional Features

- **Advanced Filtering:** Users can filter internship experiences by additional criteria such as compensation and working arrangements.
- **Favorites:** Users can save internship experiences they are interested in for later viewing.

Future Work

In the future, university internship offices could verify students' completed internships to improve the reliability of users and their shared experiences.

Team Responsibilities

Group Member	Responsibilities
Ali Kaan Koç (Step 1 Coordinator)	Coordinate the group, and communicate with the TA. Set up the GitHub repository and manage collaborator access.
Efe Osmanağaoğlu	Prepare the project proposal and decide optional feature that can be added to the application.
Kaan Bayri	Research the technologies and database requirements for the application.
Selin Ildeniz	Define the core and optional features and identify potential challenges.

GitHub Repository

https://github.com/AliKaanKoc2/InternInsight